Sreehari Rajan

Senior Java Microservices Engineer | AI Technical Leader | Distributed Systems | Cloud-Native (OpenShift, Istio) | Banking Technology

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Summary

Engineering and technical leader with 13+ years of experience building distributed, cloud-native microservices for banking and insurance platforms, including 5+ years in technical leadership. Currently lead 10 developers supporting approximately 80 production Java/Spring Boot microservices for Nationwide Building Society (NBS), deployed on OpenShift with the Istio service mesh as middleware for traffic management, service-to-service security and observability. Experienced in application support, production incident resolution, CI/CD, Linux shell scripting and IBM WebSphere exposure within NBS. Collaborate with solution and security architects, delivery managers, testers and operations stakeholders to deliver secure, reliable services. Previous Deputy Manager and Team Leader experience includes engineering management, client coordination and ISO 27001 certification leadership.

Core Competencies

- **Languages and frameworks:** Java, Python, PHP (Laravel), Spring, Spring Boot, Spring WebFlux (Project Reactor), FastAPI, J2EE, REST, SOAP, JWT, OAuth 2.0, Android (Java)
- **Architecture and design:** Large-scale distributed systems, client-server architectures, object-oriented design, data structures and algorithms, synchronous and asynchronous design patterns, scalable web services and infrastructure
- **Data:** MySQL, MongoDB, relational (transactional) and NoSQL databases, SQL and query optimisation, schema and database design
- **Cloud, platforms and DevOps:** Linux platform and shell scripting, IBM WebSphere (NBS), OpenShift (OCP), Istio service mesh, AWS (EKS, S3), Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Harness, Git, CI/CD and release support
- **Service mesh and security:** Istio service mesh as middleware for API traffic management and service-to-service security, with observability handled outside the Java application; JWT, OAuth 2.0, role-based access control; ISO 27001 certification leadership
- **Messaging and observability:** Kafka, logging, monitoring, audit trails
- **Performance and JVM:** Garbage collection, memory management, concurrency, performance tuning; unit testing with JUnit; performance testing with JMeter, ReadyAPI, Postman, SoapUI
- **AI and agents:** LLM integration, MCP servers, agentic AI workflows, AI-assisted development
- **Leadership and delivery:** Application delivery coordination, release readiness, cross-team validation, production support, incident escalation, technical leadership, technical roadmap planning, code/design reviews, mentoring, hiring and stakeholder status communication

Professional Experience

IBM, Advisory System Analyst (Cloud & Microservices Leader)

Oct 2021 - Present | Bengaluru, India (Hybrid)

Client: Nationwide Building Society (NBS), the world's largest building society, with 15M+ UK members across mortgage lending and savings. The Java team builds and maintains Spring Boot microservices for core banking operations and customer interactions. Team: Payments (alongside the Banking, Lending and Party teams), responsible for critical credit card, debit card, net banking and ATM APIs.

- Technical lead for 3 years, managing a team of 10 developers and technical delivery across approximately 80 production microservices for critical payments applications; coordinate development priorities, quality reviews and operational escalations.
- Deploy the APIs on OpenShift with the Istio service mesh as the middleware layer, so a significant part of traffic management, service-to-service security and observability is handled by the mesh outside the Java application code.
- Lead code and design reviews and mentor developers, setting best practices and standards for quality, security, performance, maintainability and craftsmanship.
- Applied Linux command-line and shell scripting knowledge in the NBS application environment to support troubleshooting and repeatable operational tasks.
- Worked with IBM WebSphere in the NBS environment, bringing middleware awareness to application troubleshooting and coordination with platform support teams.
- Serve as a key technical escalation point for application and production issues, coordinating investigation, root-cause analysis, corrective actions and communication with relevant engineering and support teams.
- Built customer, account and transaction services for savings, current and deposit accounts, covering account creation, balance enquiry, fund transfers, transaction processing and validation.
- Implemented secure API authentication and authorization using JWT and role-based access control.
- Built reporting and analytics capabilities for customer activity, account utilization and transactions.
- Serve on the IBM and NBS technical hiring panels and mentor new recruits across the 160-developer NBS business unit.
- Coordinate with client solution and security architects, build and delivery managers, designers and testing SMEs through refinement, solution validation and build handoff; clarify dependencies, raise delivery risks and communicate technical status.
- Design and build large-scale services and infrastructure for critical payments APIs, making architectural trade-offs between synchronous and asynchronous patterns (REST, Spring WebFlux, Kafka) for scalability, latency and resilience.
- Support controlled application delivery through JUnit testing, peer review, Git-based version control and Jenkins/Harness CI/CD pipelines, promoting release quality and adherence to engineering standards.

Reliability and Incident Reduction

- Implemented logging, monitoring, observability and audit trails across services for transaction traceability, compliance and faster incident analysis.
- Handled 10 P1 production incidents in 2026 as part of application support, investigating failures across approximately 80 services, guiding remediation and supporting restoration within incident SLA windows of 8–18 hours.
- Built LISA (below), which runs before services go to the NFT (performance testing) team and catches memory leaks, code that needs optimization and SLA misses (for example, APIs missing a 500 ms response time and 15 TPS throughput target), with detailed reports. In its first 2 months it flagged issues on 10 APIs.
- Introduced AI-assisted code reviews (Code Lens agent) to catch defects and quality issues before they reach production.

Agentic AI and Innovation

- **LISA (Lifecycle Inspection and Analysis):** Created a performance-testing and analysis tool for NBS as an innovation initiative. It integrates LLMs and MCP servers, uses Python engines for file reading and report generation, and is delivered as an IntelliJ plugin and through the Claude run command. The goal is a unified testing platform for NBS.
- **LISA roadmap:** Planned LISA as a phased roadmap in which each short-term release ladders to the long-term mission of a unified testing platform for NBS. Phase 1 (load testing and SLA validation from OpenAPI specs) is delivered and flagged issues on 10 APIs in its first 2 months. Later phases add performance analytics, OWASP API Top 10 vulnerability assessment and deeper memory-leak detection, while delivery grows from a command-line utility to an IntelliJ plugin and agentic AI experience. Each phase reuses the same core engines, so earlier work compounds.
- **Design-to-Build agent:** Built an agent that accelerates turning designs into working service code.
- **Code Lens agent:** Built an agent that assists with code reviews.
- Critical resource for implementing agentic AI in the client environment, evangelising AI tooling to improve engineering productivity.

Toyota Tsusho Insurance Broker India Pvt Ltd

Jan 2017 - Oct 2021 | Bengaluru, India | Technical leadership: Apr 2019 - Oct 2021

Deputy Manager (Apr 2021 - Oct 2021)

- Architect in charge of web applications built on Java microservices, including new data analytics functionality.
- Tuned web application performance: web service optimisation, SQL query optimisation and overall response time.
- Led the company's ISO 27001 information security certification, coordinating with the external consultancy Samudita (Bangalore) and cross-functional teams to meet security and compliance requirements.

Team Leader and Assistant Manager (Apr 2019 - Apr 2021)

- Recruited, mentored and managed engineers while overseeing development delivery and technical operations for the Yamaha OEM dealer insurance platform (We Care Yamaha), including stakeholder follow-ups and delivery coordination.
- Designed and built RESTful APIs with JWT and OAuth 2.0, and integrated third-party REST and SOAP APIs (payment and SMS gateways) with TATA, HDFC, Religare and Star India. Also worked with PHP web applications on the Laravel platform.
- Handled requirements gathering, proposals, client follow-ups and Scrum management.
- Led design and delivery of large-scale client-server distributed platforms: the Toyota car insurance issuance platform and the Yamaha Motors We Care Yamaha program (about 5 years across both).
- Worked with multiple insurers (National Insurance, Tata AIG, HDFC Ergo, IFFCO Tokio): attended their technical leadership meetings, presented platform features and security, collected feedback and implemented it.
- Used SQL relational databases as the base datastore for the Toyota and Yamaha platforms, with some modules on MongoDB.

Associate Web Developer (Jan 2017 - Apr 2019)

- Lead developer for InstaInsure, a B2C insurance selling platform; also built Toyota Protect for Toyota car customers, an MIS tool for business teams, and an HDFC Ergo campaign app, working with PHP web applications on the Laravel platform.

Key Projects

- **Toyota Protect:** Platform used by Toyota and Lexus car showrooms across India to issue car insurance policies for customers and renew them yearly; integrated with insurers through the integrator Binary Semantics. Technology: ASP.NET, jQuery, React (UI), Azure.
- **Eicher Care:** Platform used by Eicher truck showrooms across India to issue vehicle insurance policies for customers and renew them yearly. Technology: ASP.NET, jQuery, React (UI), Azure.
- **We Care Yamaha:** Platform built and maintained by our team, used by Yamaha dealerships to issue and renew policies for customers. Integrated with Tata AIG, IFFCO Tokio, Cholamandalam, HDFC, United India Insurance, Digit and others for policy issuance (issue, renew, raise claims) and their payment gateways. Technology: Java Spring Boot, PHP Laravel, React, Azure, SQL.
- **InstaInsure:** Online platform for buying and renewing consumer health, travel and motor insurance. Customers enter their details, compare quotes from multiple insurers with breakups, features and conditions, then check out and buy a policy. Technology: Java Spring Boot, PHP Laravel, React, Azure, SQL.

Hardesen Technologies

Software Developer and Technology Evangelist | Feb 2013 - Nov 2016 | Trivandrum, India

- Built J2EE applications (JSP, Servlets), REST and SOAP web services, and Android apps using object-oriented design and Agile practices.
- Integrated third-party APIs (PayPal, Google, Facebook, eBay) and handled relational databases and version control.

Key Projects

- **SAM, Sales Assessment and Monitoring Platform:** Web and Android platform to streamline sales operations, performance tracking and field workforce management. Managers set daily, weekly and monthly sales targets, assign tasks to sales representatives and monitor target achievement; representatives record daily activities, manage tasks, update client interactions, document meeting summaries and business requirements, and track task completion times. Integrated GPS route tracking in the Android app, with cloud synchronization and Google Maps visualization of field routes for managers and employees. Implemented automated, scheduled daily performance reports with configurable insights into sales activity, target completion, field movements and productivity. Deployed on a VPS cloud server. Technology: ASP.NET, Java, Android, Google Maps API, VPS cloud server.
- **Warehouse Management System for DHL Logistics:** Web-based WMS to streamline warehouse operations, inventory management and logistics workflows, covering inventory tracking, stock inward and outward processing, order management, shipment coordination and warehouse reporting. Deployed on a VPS cloud server for centralized access, secure operations and reliable performance. Technology: PHP (Yii Framework), jQuery, MySQL, VPS cloud server.

Personal Projects

- **Android voice recorder app:** Built a voice recording android app named WaveStudio Pro in Java for my SreeStories Youtube channel.
- **Multi-stream live broadcasting platform:** Building a platform to broadcast one live stream from OBS Studio to YouTube, Facebook and Instagram at once, for the SreeStories (my YouTube channel), as a way to learn restream-style scalable streaming pipelines. Architecture: OBS Studio, NGINX RTMP ingest, FFmpeg distribution. Stack: Spring Boot streaming orchestration API, Laravel dashboard and user managem ent, Docker, cloud hosting.

Education

- **Master's Degree, Computer Science**, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, 2012 - 2014 (ACM ICPC 2012, 2013)
- **Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science**, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, 2007 - 2010

Certifications

- Claude Certified Developer - Foundations, Anthropic (2026)
- IBM Generative and Agentic AI Foundation, IBM (2026)
- IBM Banking Industry Jumpstart, IBM (2026)
- IBM Certified Advocate - Cloud v1; Build Smart on Kubernetes; IBM Cloud Essentials v3, IBM (2021)
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, AWS (2022)